Market Brief - offline copy

Snapshot taken Wednesday 21 October 2026, 13:01 (Europe/Madrid). Data is frozen at that time. Links open the original articles when you are online.

Daily overview

Markets over the last day: the eight tracked equity indices moved +0.34% on average, with Dow Jones strongest (+1.02%) and Hang Seng weakest (-0.90%). Brent crude changed +1.90% to 110.86. Gold changed +0.06% to 4,145.0. Bitcoin changed +0.49% to 83,350.1172. The US 10-year yield stands at 5.117%, a relative move of -0.37%. Among the firms tracked, 3i Group (-3.35%) and Jefferies (+3.23%) moved the most.

Deals and capital markets: Submit a question: Could Anthropic's IPO be a turning point for AI? (FT Markets). Join us for a live Ask an Expert Q&A with Richard Waters, the FT's tech writer at large, and George Hammond, the FT's venture capital correspondent, at 8am (PDT)/4pm (BST) on Thursday October 22 Deals and capital markets: Microsoft gives data centre hopefuls a pre-IPO reality check (FT Companies). The US tech giant calling time on its Nscale deal exposes faultlines running through this fast-growing area of the AI sector Central banks and macro: UK September inflation fuels expectations of imminent BoE rate rise (FT World). Headline and core inflation accelerates ahead of November meeting Central banks and macro: UK inflation and borrowing top forecasts in blow to Healey (FT World). Figure comes ahead of next week's Budget and will cement expectations of Bank of England rate rise in November

Weekly overview

Markets over the past seven days: the eight tracked equity indices moved -1.18% on average, with Dow Jones strongest (+1.60%) and Nikkei 225 weakest (-4.61%). Brent crude changed +4.53% to 110.86. Gold changed +0.90% to 4,145.0. Bitcoin changed +2.27% to 83,350.1172. The US 10-year yield stands at 5.117%, a relative move of -1.92%. Among the firms tracked, Bank of America (-6.15%) and BlackRock (+5.87%) moved the most.

Deals and capital markets: Submit a question: Could Anthropic's IPO be a turning point for AI? (FT Markets). Join us for a live Ask an Expert Q&A with Richard Waters, the FT's tech writer at large, and George Hammond, the FT's venture capital correspondent, at 8am (PDT)/4pm (BST) on Thursday October 22 Deals and capital markets: Private equity finds next Asian frontier (FT Markets). Foreign firms make up majority of large buyout deals in continent's fourth-biggest economy Central banks and macro: UK September inflation fuels expectations of imminent BoE rate rise (FT World). Headline and core inflation accelerates ahead of November meeting Central banks and macro: US inflation jumps to 3.7% as Iran war drives up prices (FT World). Rebound in fuel costs has piled pressure on voters ahead of midterm elections Geopolitics and trade: Iran war sparks heating crisis in US north-east as winter approaches (FT World). Record heating oil prices are forcing the region to rethink prior opposition to natural gas pipelines

Major news by sector (past 7 days)

IPOs & Listings

Microsoft gives data centre hopefuls a pre-IPO reality check

FT Companies | 20 Oct 06:00

The US tech giant calling time on its Nscale deal exposes faultlines running through this fast-growing area of the AI sector

Ambani looks to pull off India's biggest IPO

FT Markets | 20 Oct 02:33

Jio Platforms aims to list at $107bn valuation amid stock market downturn, tougher competition and goading from Elon Musk

Listings in south-east Asia gain momentum with $1bn IPO

FT Markets | 18 Oct 03:00

Owner of digital wallet GCash set to start trading in region's biggest debut this year

Waiting for good IPO

FT Markets | 20 Oct 07:30

Anthropic’s shrinking window to list

General Atlantic’s IPO ambitions

FT Markets | 15 Oct 06:00

The private capital group is planning to go public in the first half of next year as it seeks to keep pace with listed rivals like Blackstone and Apollo Global

The data centre IPO debacle that sparked a market meltdown

FT Markets | 16 Oct 06:54

Decisions by Australian groups Firmus and AirTrunk have added to concerns about the AI borrowing frenzy

M&A & Deals

Private equity finds next Asian frontier

FT Markets | 19 Oct 03:30

Foreign firms make up majority of large buyout deals in continent’s fourth-biggest economy

Credit Suisse bankers denied bonuses stripped after UBS takeover

FT World | 15 Oct 13:46

Switzerland’s top court sides with government decision, overturning ruling of lower court

India approves biggest foreign takeover of domestic bank

FT Companies | 15 Oct 09:19

Canada’s Fairfax Financial Holdings to buy nearly 61% of IDBI Bank for $5.6bn

Why is Elon Musk plotting a mega-merger of SpaceX and Tesla?

BBC Business | 21 Oct 08:36

Musk says there's "a lot to be gained" by combining the firms in what would be the biggest merger in history.

FirstFT: SpaceX and Tesla explore merger

FT World | 21 Oct 11:40

Also in today’s newsletter: Netanyahu pushes to resume large-scale strikes against Iran and French borrowing costs hit 5% for the first time since 2002

SpaceX and Tesla boards explore potential merger

FT Companies | 21 Oct 03:49

Elon Musk says combining his two public companies would be a ‘good idea’ as the world approaches an AI singularity

Private Equity, VC & Angels

Submit a question: Could Anthropic’s IPO be a turning point for AI?

FT Markets | 20 Oct 22:57

Join us for a live Ask an Expert Q&A with Richard Waters, the FT’s tech writer at large, and George Hammond, the FT’s venture capital correspondent, at 8am (PDT)/4pm (BST) on Thursday October 22

Private equity group Charlesbank closes one of the biggest law firm deals

FT Markets | 19 Oct 06:00

Stake in Wood Smith Henning & Berman could herald wave of investments in US liability defence firms

KKR accused by EU of misleading regulators over €22bn telecoms deal

FT Companies | 19 Oct 13:32

Private equity group disputes it gave false or misleading information to Brussels as it sought clearance for FiberCop deal

New York pensions chief says private equity firm sought to expense jet use

FT Markets | 19 Oct 23:18

Head of city’s $326bn Retirement Systems hits out at ‘steady creep’ higher in fees charged by managers

Private equity interest endangers London float of former DS Smith business

FT Markets | 15 Oct 15:13

Lone Star and Atlas Holdings consider offers after owner International Paper announced plans to float the division in London

Asset Management

BlackRock pulls in $205bn to take assets to record high

FT Markets | 14 Oct 13:39

World’s largest asset manager has become an increasingly powerful force in private capital after acquisitions of HPS and Global Infrastructure Partners

Banking

Robot factories and hypersonic missiles: JPMorgan Chase's first $5 billion of defense investments

CNBC | 19 Oct 14:34

With $5 billion already deployed off its balance sheet, JPMorgan Chase is racing ahead on direct investments in defense tech, hardware and supply chains.

Central Banks & Macro

UK September inflation fuels expectations of imminent BoE rate rise

FT World | 21 Oct 09:03

Headline and core inflation accelerates ahead of November meeting

US inflation jumps to 3.7% as Iran war drives up prices

FT World | 14 Oct 18:18

Rebound in fuel costs has piled pressure on voters ahead of midterm elections

UK inflation and borrowing top forecasts in blow to Healey

FT World | 21 Oct 09:18

Figure comes ahead of next week’s Budget and will cement expectations of Bank of England rate rise in November

Piero Cipollone: Pontes and Appia: unlocking opportunities for banks

ECB | 21 Oct 10:00

No summary in feed.

Philip R. Lane: Euro liquidity lines and the international monetary system

ECB | 21 Oct 06:15

No summary in feed.

Trump has failed to listen to voters on inflation

FT World | 16 Oct 16:58

People elect presidents to fix problems, not to diagnose their causes

Geopolitics & Trade

Iran war sparks heating crisis in US north-east as winter approaches

FT World | 21 Oct 12:00

Record heating oil prices are forcing the region to rethink prior opposition to natural gas pipelines

How will Big Oil spend its $32bn Iran war windfall?

FT Markets | 15 Oct 06:00

Investors are keen to see how the world's largest crude companies plan to deploy extra cash generated by soaring energy prices

EU vows to maintain Russia sanctions after US pivot

FT World | 16 Oct 17:46

European leaders close ranks around Volodymyr Zelenskyy following Donald Trump's fuel deal with Moscow

Trump exempts Russia from further sanctions mandated by new law

FT Markets | 17 Oct 11:53

US president gives Putin a reprieve on threatened energy measures after cutting deal with Moscow to release diesel

Are we sleepwalking into World War III?

FT World | 17 Oct 06:00

As regional conflicts rage and revisionist powers challenge the established order, warnings of a new global conflagration are growing louder

Who's winning the trade war with China? You asked, we answered

FT World | 15 Oct 14:00

Senior trade writer Alan Beattie and economics columnist Soumaya Keynes replied to reader questions

Commodities & Energy

Investors predict new record price for gold within two years

FT Markets | 15 Oct 06:00

Central banks in September made their highest monthly purchases of the precious metal for almost two years

Markets

Equities	Last	Day	Week
S&P 500	7,712.5698	+0.28%	-1.19%
Nasdaq	26,424.8203	-0.02%	-2.87%
Dow Jones	52,495.8789	+1.02%	+1.60%
FTSE 100	10,738.4199	+0.05%	+0.13%
DAX	25,479.3008	+0.69%	+0.71%
Nikkei 225	64,621.2383	+0.85%	-4.61%
Hang Seng	23,651.8691	-0.90%	-2.85%
Euro Stoxx 50	6,166.9102	+0.74%	-0.38%

Currencies	Last	Day	Week
EUR/USD	1.1235	+0.17%	+0.28%
GBP/USD	1.3393	+0.64%	+1.03%
USD/JPY	158.03	-0.31%	-0.18%
USD/CNY	6.6645	-0.39%	-0.41%

Bonds	Last	Day	Week
US 5Y yield	4.935	+0.12%	-1.44%
US 10Y yield	5.117	-0.37%	-1.92%
US 30Y yield	5.425	-0.86%	-2.48%

Financial sector	Last	Day	Week
US Financials (XLF)	55.72	+1.20%	+1.64%
US Banks (KBE)	64.36	+1.96%	+2.26%
Europe Financials (EUFN)	38.45	+0.87%	-0.75%

Energy	Last	Day	Week
Brent crude	110.86	+1.90%	+4.53%
WTI crude	99.95	-1.81%	+5.11%
Natural gas	2.857	-3.58%	-10.66%

Metals	Last	Day	Week
Gold	4,145.0	+0.06%	+0.90%
Silver	57.675	-0.05%	+3.83%
Copper	6.5545	-0.18%	-0.86%

Agriculture	Last	Day	Week
Wheat	639.0	-0.66%	-5.09%
Corn	459.75	-0.49%	-4.37%
Soybeans	1,245.0	-0.26%	-2.52%
Coffee	316.45	+1.65%	+6.17%

Crypto	Last	Day	Week
Bitcoin	83,350.1172	+0.49%	+2.27%
Ethereum	2,456.9299	+0.42%	+1.54%

Investment Banks	Last	Day	Week
Goldman Sachs	884.81	+1.03%	-0.80%
Morgan Stanley	180.4	+1.08%	-3.34%
JPMorgan	335.26	+0.52%	+1.16%
Bank of America	50.64	+0.50%	-6.15%
Citigroup	122.51	+0.67%	-1.62%
UBS	47.23	+0.51%	-1.30%
Deutsche Bank	31.7	+0.22%	-4.92%
Barclays	22.33	+0.72%	-3.17%
HSBC	92.74	-0.24%	-2.22%

Santander	13.13	+0.84%	-3.10%
BBVA	25.49	+0.95%	-2.01%
Lazard	36.67	+2.98%	+0.41%
Evercore	252.1	+1.67%	-4.49%
Jefferies	45.01	+3.23%	+0.33%

Asset Managers & Private Equity	**Last**	**Day**	**Week**
BlackRock	1,128.6801	+0.36%	+5.87%
Blackstone	110.34	+3.03%	+0.33%
KKR	89.21	+2.54%	+2.35%
Apollo	111.22	+0.24%	-4.35%
Carlyle	37.31	+2.05%	+0.19%
Ares Management	116.29	+2.91%	+0.58%
T. Rowe Price	102.13	+2.03%	+0.73%
Franklin Templeton	31.24	+1.73%	+0.19%
Invesco	28.78	+1.73%	-0.48%
3i Group	2,338.874	-3.35%	-2.79%
Schroders	589.0	+0.00%	+0.08%
Amundi	88.4	+0.68%	-0.17%
EQT	293.3	-1.25%	+4.15%

Exchanges & Payments	**Last**	**Day**	**Week**
Intercontinental Exchange	158.57	+0.11%	+1.37%
CME Group	295.31	+0.61%	+6.22%
Nasdaq Inc.	94.8	+1.72%	+1.41%
LSEG	8,743.2002	-0.01%	+4.11%
Deutsche Boerse	307.6	-0.42%	+1.32%
Visa	406.57	+0.91%	+2.65%
Mastercard	620.42	+0.65%	+2.58%

Oil & Gas Majors	**Last**	**Day**	**Week**
ExxonMobil	177.86	-0.24%	+2.17%
Chevron	225.71	+0.60%	+3.67%
Shell	105.54	+0.69%	+2.48%
BP	49.39	-0.10%	+1.77%
TotalEnergies	90.08	+0.14%	+1.27%
ConocoPhillips	145.95	+0.49%	+3.58%
Equinor	45.76	-0.85%	+1.64%
Occidental	62.92	+0.32%	+2.06%
US Oil Fund (ETF)	160.61	-0.12%	+4.91%

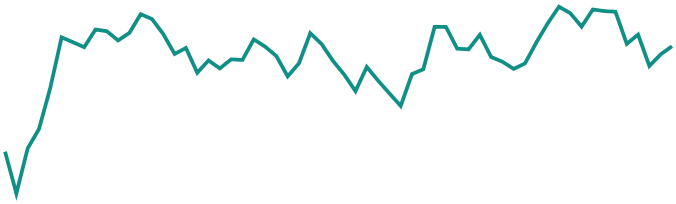
Mining & Metals	**Last**	**Day**	**Week**
BHP	81.87	-1.62%	-3.63%
Rio Tinto	88.16	-1.50%	-5.27%

Glencore	554.1	+0.75%	-4.02%
Freeport-McMoRan	68.87	-1.26%	-4.70%
Newmont	116.81	-1.02%	+1.06%
Vale	13.02	-0.69%	-2.62%
Gold Miners (ETF)	86.1	-0.43%	-1.31%

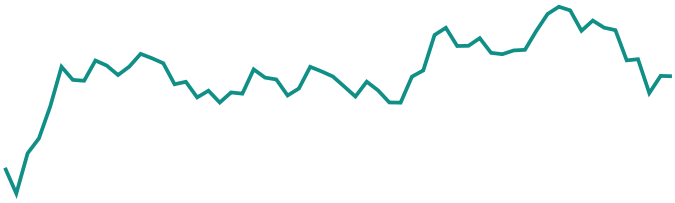
Big Tech & IPO Barometer	Last	Day	Week
Nvidia	216.47	-0.29%	-5.27%
Microsoft	531.87	-0.31%	-2.13%
Apple	339.5	-1.00%	-0.52%
Amazon	262.63	+0.07%	+1.57%
Alphabet	340.28	-1.13%	-3.82%
Meta	694.25	-1.59%	-8.95%
Tesla	373.71	+1.54%	-0.41%
Renaissance IPO (ETF)	49.5	+0.90%	-4.37%

Key charts (last 60 trading days)

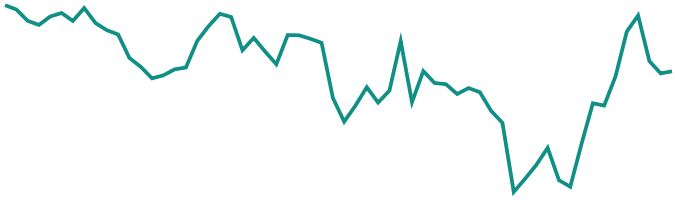
S&P 500: low 7316.15, high 7818.93, last 7712.57



Nasdaq: low 24442.9, high 27599.8, last 26424.8

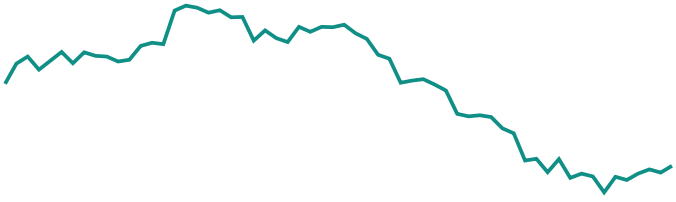


FTSE 100: low 10428.3, high 10908.4, last 10738.4

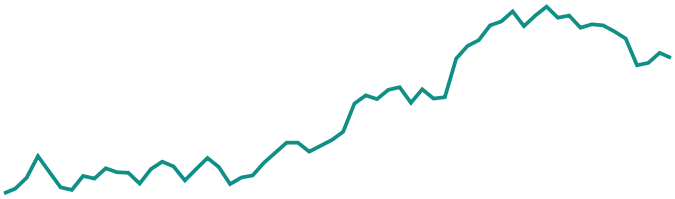


DAX: low 24807, high 26570, last 25479.3

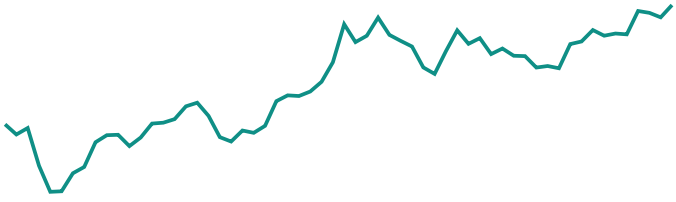
EUR/USD: low 1.116, high 1.1688, last 1.1235



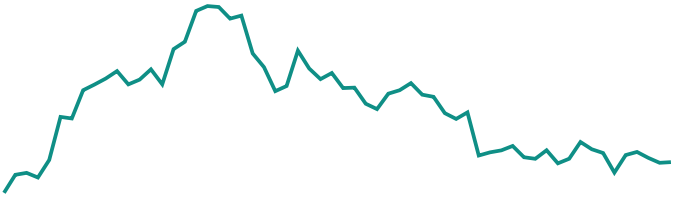
US 10Y yield: low 4.604, high 5.311, last 5.117

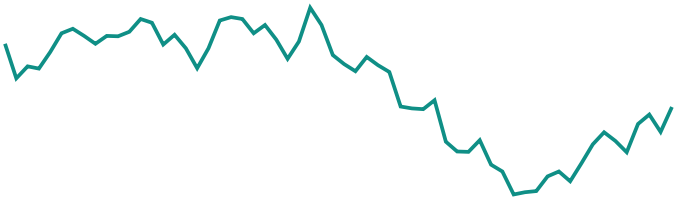


Brent crude: low 79.36, high 110.86, last 110.86



Gold: low 4036.3, high 4697.8, last 4145



Bitcoin: low 75612.5, high 86602.9, last 83350.1

US Financials (XLF): low 53.4, high 58.3535, last 55.72